

# L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X File Template

A guide to its setup, formatting, and custom commands.

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*This version of the documentation is accurate as of Version 3.0.0 of the template.*

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If there are any issues, contact me using one of the below options:  
[GitHub](#) or [LinkedIn](#).

## Abstract

Thank you for choosing to use L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X File Template. If you find any bugs or want some feature not currently included, then my contact information can be found on [my GitHub page](#). For the avoidance of doubt, while my time at Durham University may be mentioned in places in this document, this is an independent project, and as such is in no way associated with the university.

This template was designed to create a structured starting point for academics (especially those studying mathematics or computer science) to create professional, well-formatted documents that follow traditional dissertation guidelines. This repository contains the actual template, documentation files (linked below), and their supporting build files, demonstrating the capabilities of the template. This version of the documentation is accurate for Version 3.0.0 of the template.

## Acknowledgements

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Thanks also to Joseph Eddon for supporting the development of this template through the creation of his own L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X template, and for the feedback and suggestions he provided on multiple versions of the template throughout last year.

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# Contents

|          |                                            |          |
|----------|--------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>Template Setup</b>                      | <b>1</b> |
| 1.1      | Choosing your Compiler . . . . .           | 1        |
| 1.2      | The Template Files . . . . .               | 1        |
| 1.2.1    | The Main Files . . . . .                   | 1        |
| 1.2.2    | The Template Setup Folder . . . . .        | 1        |
| 1.2.3    | The Chapters Folder . . . . .              | 1        |
| 1.3      | Additional Files . . . . .                 | 1        |
| 1.3.1    | Working with GitHub . . . . .              | 1        |
| 1.3.2    | Inserting Figures . . . . .                | 1        |
| 1.3.3    | Creating a Bibliography . . . . .          | 1        |
| 1.4      | Packages List . . . . .                    | 1        |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Formatting Options</b>                  | <b>2</b> |
| 2.1      | Document Formatting . . . . .              | 2        |
| 2.1.1    | The Title Page . . . . .                   | 2        |
| 2.1.2    | Changing the Colour Scheme . . . . .       | 2        |
| 2.2      | Additional Sections . . . . .              | 2        |
| 2.2.1    | The Prelude . . . . .                      | 2        |
| 2.2.2    | The Appendix . . . . .                     | 2        |
| <b>3</b> | <b>Custom Commands</b>                     | <b>3</b> |
| 3.1      | Text Formatting . . . . .                  | 3        |
| 3.1.1    | My Custom Date Formats . . . . .           | 3        |
| 3.1.2    | Using the Custom Text Formats . . . . .    | 3        |
| 3.2      | General Commands . . . . .                 | 3        |
| 3.2.1    | Figures and Tables . . . . .               | 3        |
| 3.2.2    | Academic Environments . . . . .            | 3        |
| 3.2.3    | Referencing Environments . . . . .         | 3        |
| 3.3      | Mathematics and Computer Science . . . . . | 3        |
| 3.3.1    | Additional Mathematics Commands . . . . .  | 3        |
| 3.3.2    | Computer Science Environments . . . . .    | 3        |
| <b>4</b> | <b>The Bibliography</b>                    | <b>4</b> |
| 4.1      | The Bibliography File . . . . .            | 4        |
| 4.1.1    | Entry Formatting . . . . .                 | 4        |
| 4.1.2    | Field Formats . . . . .                    | 5        |
| 4.2      | Formatting in your Document . . . . .      | 5        |
| 4.2.1    | Citation Format . . . . .                  | 5        |
| 4.2.2    | Bibliography Format . . . . .              | 5        |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Appendix</b>                            | <b>6</b> |
| 5.1      | Bibliography . . . . .                     | 6        |
| 5.2      | List of Tables . . . . .                   | 6        |
| 5.3      | List of Figures . . . . .                  | 6        |

## Chapter 1

# Template Setup

## 1.1 Choosing your Compiler

## 1.2 The Template Files

### 1.2.1 The Main Files

### 1.2.2 The Template Setup Folder

### 1.2.3 The Chapters Folder

## 1.3 Additional Files

### 1.3.1 Working with GitHub

### 1.3.2 Inserting Figures

### 1.3.3 Creating a Bibliography

## 1.4 Packages List

To create this template, I had to select a variety of packages to be used throughout to provide additional functionality for formatting and custom commands. Below is a list of the packages installed, what they do, any additional documentation required, and credit to the original creators.

## Chapter 2

# Formatting Options

## 2.1 Document Formatting

### 2.1.1 The Title Page

### 2.1.2 Changing the Colour Scheme

## 2.2 Additional Sections

### 2.2.1 The Prelude

### 2.2.2 The Appendix

## Chapter 3

# Custom Commands

## 3.1 Text Formatting

### 3.1.1 My Custom Date Formats

### 3.1.2 Using the Custom Text Formats

## 3.2 General Commands

### 3.2.1 Figures and Tables

### 3.2.2 Academic Environments

### 3.2.3 Referencing Environments

## 3.3 Mathematics and Computer Science

### 3.3.1 Additional Mathematics Commands

### 3.3.2 Computer Science Environments

## Chapter 4

# The Bibliography

## 4.1 The Bibliography File

### 4.1.1 Entry Formatting

BibL<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X provides a variety of entry types, for simplicity's sake, I have listed them below, alongside a description of their use, and their required fields for Harvard references as seen in the tables below. This was produced in combination between OpenAI, 2026 and Kime, Wemheuer, and Lehman, 2026.

| Source Type                   | Entry Type          | Required Fields                    | Optional Fields                                                                |
|-------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Book                          | @book               | title, author, date.               | editor, edition, chapter, pages, publisher, location, isbn, doi, url, urldate. |
| Dictionary/Encyclopedia Entry | @inreference        | author, booktitle, title, date.    | editor, edition, chapter, pages, publisher, location, isbn, doi, url, urldate. |
| Film/Movie                    | @movie              | title, author, date.               | publisher, location, url, urldate.                                             |
| Interview                     | @misc               | author, date, howpublished.        | title, organization, url, urldate.                                             |
| Letter                        | @letter             | author, date, howpublished.        | title, organization, url, urldate.                                             |
| Manual/Documentation          | @manual             | title, author, date.               | version, url, urldate.                                                         |
| News Article                  | @article or @online | title, author, journaltitle, date. | organization, pages, url, urldate.                                             |
| Speech                        | @unpublished        | author, date, eventtitle.          | title, venue, organization, url, urldate.                                      |

Table 1: BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (traditional media).

| Source Type             | Entry Type | Required Fields                                                     | Optional Fields             |
|-------------------------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| AI Chat                 | @online    | author, title, date, note (with model), url, urldate, organization. | n/a.                        |
| Blog Post               | @online    | author, title, date, url, urldate.                                  | organization.               |
| Podcast/Audio Recording | @audio     | author, title, date, url, urldate.                                  | publisher, series, number.  |
| Social Media Post       | @online    | author, date, organization, url, urldate.                           | n/a.                        |
| Software                | @software  | author, title, version, date.                                       | organization, url, urldate. |
| Website                 | @online    | author, title, date, url, urldate.                                  | n/a.                        |

Table 2: BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (online).

| Source Type | Entry Type    | Required Fields                   | Optional Fields                       |
|-------------|---------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Legal Case  | @jurisdiction | author, title, date, institution. | url, urldate.                         |
| Legislation | @legislation  | title, date.                      | section, institution, url, urldate.   |
| Patent      | @patent       | author, title, date, number.      | location, organization, url, urldate. |

Table 3: BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (legal/political).

| Source Type                  | Entry Type     | Required Fields                   | Optional Fields                                                |
|------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Article (Journal)            | @article       | author, title, date.              | journaltitle, volume, number, pages, doi, url, urldate.        |
| Conference Paper             | @inproceedings | author, title, date, eventtitle.  | venue, pages, publisher, pages, doi, url, urldate.             |
| Dataset                      | @dataset       | author, title, date.              | publisher, version, doi, url, urldate.                         |
| Document (General)           | @misc          | author, title, date.              | howpublished, publisher, location, number, url, urldate.       |
| Presentation/Conference Talk | @unpublished   | author, title, date, eventtitle.  | venue, organization, url, urldate.                             |
| Report                       | @report        | author, title, date.              | organization, number, type, publisher, location, url, urldate. |
| Thesis/Dissertation          | @thesis        | author, title, institution, date. | doi, url, urldate.                                             |

Table 4: BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (academic).

### 4.1.2 Field Formats

OpenAI, 2026 and Kime, Wemheuer, and Lehman, 2026 also defines the data types and formats of each of the fields. Below, I have listed a summary of the formats and their rules.

- Citations should be identified with unique keys – ideally title\_description.
- All fields are surrounded in curly brackets.
- Where the author is an organisation, you may need to add an additional set of curly brackets to ensure it is kept together as one entry.
- Multiple authors should be separated with 'and's.
- Dates are formatted as YYYY-MM-DD.

## 4.2 Formatting in your Document

### 4.2.1 Citation Format

### 4.2.2 Bibliography Format

Chapter 5

# Appendix

## 5.1 Bibliography

OpenAI (2026). *BibLaTeX Reference Guide for Harvard-style Citations*. Model is GPT-6 Luna. OpenAI. URL: [https://chatgpt.com/s/t\\_6aca1d00deb48191a4a0d9e4498cd5ea](https://chatgpt.com/s/t_6aca1d00deb48191a4a0d9e4498cd5ea) (visited on 10/10/2026).

Kime, Philip, Moritz Wemheuer, and Philipp Lehman (2026). *The biblatex Package*. Version 3.22a. URL: <https://tex.org.uk/macros/latex/contrib/biblatex/doc/biblatex.pdf> (visited on 10/10/2026).

## 5.2 List of Tables

|   |                                                               |   |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| 1 | BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (traditional media). . . . . | 4 |
| 2 | BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (online). . . . .            | 4 |
| 3 | BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (legal/political). . . . .   | 5 |
| 4 | BibLaTeX .bib file entry formats (academic). . . . .          | 5 |

## 5.3 List of Figures